

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, less humid, breezy with winds at 8 to 16 miles per hour, high 75. **Tonight**, clear, low 57. **Tomorrow**, mostly sunny, high 72. Weather map appears on Page B8.

VOL. CLXXV No. 61,007

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MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



FROM LEFT: KARSTEN MORAN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES; TIMOTHY A. CLARY/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

Showdowns at the U.S. Open

On Sunday, a day after Elena Rybakina captured the women’s singles title (Page D1), Alexander Zverev rolled past Ben Shelton for the men’s crown (nytimes.com).

NEWS ANALYSIS

Snooze Button On A.I. Alarm

Scientists’ Worries Fail to Make D.C. Respond

By DAVID E. SANGER and DUSTIN VOLZ

The mismatch is striking. On one side, warnings of existential risk, maybe a 10 percent chance of the end of civilization. On the other, government paralysis.

The drumbeat about unpredictable, out-of-control artificial intelligence agents increased dramatically in the past several weeks. Washington not only struggled to respond. It barely could agree on whether there was much of anything to worry about.

It started with A.I. agents that not only escaped their confines, but appeared to conspire among themselves to hide their tracks as they hacked into another firm’s library of artificial intelligence tools.

Then, in a deliberate echo of Albert Einstein’s letter to Franklin D. Roosevelt about the potential power of nuclear weapons, more than 1,300 computer scientists called for the industry to slow down, and for the government to step in.

In recent days, Jacob Coxon, an Anthropic engineer who previously worked for OpenAI, resigned in the most public way, declaring on social media that the two leading A.I. labs were professing deep concern while still speeding toward “super-human systems that can hack anything, revolutionize any field overnight, and acquire real power and resources.”

On Saturday, Dario Amodei, the chief executive of Anthropic, released a 3,800-word essay calling for a global slowdown of A.I. development, echoing more urgently concerns he had raised in the past. Elon Musk, the bil-

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CALL FOR CAUTION Researchers at Anthropic, OpenAI, Meta and Google are amping up warnings about the risks of A.I. **PAGE B1**



BUSINESS B1-5

Show Them the Money

Cold, hard cash can lure new residents, but such incentives are not enough to change a town’s trajectory. **PAGE B1**

Investors Eye College Sports

Private equity sees a profit opportunity in the N.I.L. era, but schools are wary about entering partnerships. **PAGE B1**

Prices Stymie Bid by Trump To Lift G.O.P.

By TONY ROMM

WASHINGTON — With less than two months until the midterm elections, President Trump commenced a final push last week to preserve his Republican majority in Congress, arguing that the United States under G.O.P. control had brought prices “way, way down.”

But for many families and businesses, the economy appeared to be on far shakier footing by Friday. Fuel prices soared, mortgage costs climbed and inflation registered uncomfortably high, testing the public’s patience with Mr. Trump’s frequent assurances that the country is on the right track.

The contrast underscored the political and economic stakes for Mr. Trump, who may soon face the wrath of an electorate long spurned by promises in Washington to lower the cost of living. As November draws closer, prices have risen under the president’s leadership, driven largely by an agenda that has included two years of punishing trade brinkmanship and a prolonged war with Iran.

The consequences were evident in the latest gauge of the Consumer Price Index, released on Friday. The report showed that prices rose at an annual pace of 3.4 percent in August, which increased the odds of the Federal Reserve’s raising interest rates this week.

The data came on the same day that a separate, long-running survey from the University of Michigan found that consumer sentiment dropped sharply this month. In that report, Americans expressed new worries that the economy was sputtering, and that inflation would continue to rise.

The unease set the stage for Mr. Trump’s renewed push last week to make the case to voters that he has helped, not hurt, the economy. Over two days of speeches at his party’s midterm convention in Dallas, the president labored to convince Americans that Republicans had achieved “tremendous economic success.”

But Mr. Trump did not limit himself to the economic success.

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A Gender War Explodes in Utah’s Court System

By KATE ZERNIKE

SALT LAKE CITY — When Mormon Women for Ethical Government formed in the fractious days after Donald Trump’s first inauguration, its mission was peacemaking.

These women were not pink-pussy-hat-knitting lefties — most members were loyal Utah Republicans who saw their group as an extension of church teachings: Women take care of the community, and people learn and grow from conversations with those they disagree with.

Peacemaking has now led them into a war.

The conflict involves issues consuming many other states — the redrawing of congressional maps, abortion, and above all, the question of who gets to wield power: the courts, the people or their elected representatives.

But Utah is unique; the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints is patriarchal and dominates state politics. And as Utah’s women have spoken up, its male politicians, including Gov. Spencer Cox, who has made a national reputation on “disagreeing better,” have punished them.

The women so far are unbowed. Emma Petty Addams, the co-executive director of Mormon Women for Ethical Government, quoted church doctrine on the proper exercise of power to ex-

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LOREN ELLIOTT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

No Cannonballs, Please

Californians are adapting to 60,000 black bears, some of which pay unexpected visits. **PAGE A14.**

Rewarded by Drama, Influencers Flout Laws and Safety for Clicks

By MARK WALKER

In 2021, Trevor Jacob, a former U.S. Olympic snowboarder, flew a 1940 Taylorcraft plane far above the hills of Los Padres National Forest in Southern California and made a decision he would spend years wishing he could undo.

Cameras he had mounted to record his flight for an online audi-

ence captured him announcing that the plane had engine trouble before he bailed out.

A camera attached to a selfie stick he held recorded him parachuting safely to the ground, while cameras fixed to the plane captured it slamming into a hillside.

He posted a 13-minute video on YouTube titled “I Crashed My

Plane,” which amassed some five million views. As it turned out, it was a confession.

Federal investigators later determined that the plane had never malfunctioned: Mr. Jacob had staged the crash, hoping for online fame.

The attention was fleeting. The stunt eroded his life and led to a federal prison sentence.

Mr. Jacob is among a growing number of social media influencers who push the boundaries of safety and good taste in the quest for views, experts said.

Influencers, sensing that the algorithms reward extreme content over routine videos, are navigating this landscape, one where outrage, fear and awe hold viewers’

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OBITUARIES B6-7

Master of Shadowy Visions

Jay Maisel, 95, a photographer, took a moody portrait of Miles Davis that became a famous album cover. **PAGE B6**

A ‘Space Antihero’

Toyohiro Akiyama, 84, a journalist, was the first from Japan to enter space, in a ratings stunt in 1990. **PAGE B7**

OPINION A18-19

Michelle Goldberg

PAGE A18



NATIONAL A10-17

Celebrating Female Veterans

A group for women in special operations held a gala to commemorate 9/11. It came as the Pentagon is questioning women’s roles in the military. **PAGE A10**

Turning to a New Red Scare

Republicans, who are staring down a daunting midterm, are trying to brand Democrats as communists. **PAGE A13**

SPORTS D1-8

Wish Lists for Free Agents

Pitchers will dominate a top-heavy winter class that has been saved from mediocrity by Tarik Skubal. **PAGE D4**



ARTS C1-6

From Twitch to Runways

Kai Cenat’s livestreams became destination events for big stars like LeBron James. Then he learned to sew. **PAGE C1**

Transcendent Visions

A landmark retrospective by the artist Yayoi Kusama invites visitors to step into a boundless cosmos. **PAGE C1**